PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Engineer | SIEM and Detection Engineering Specialist

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)-certified Senior Cyber Security Engineer with over five years of experience designing, engineering and operating enterprise Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) platforms and detection pipelines. I hold deep expertise in CrowdStrike Falcon Next-Generation SIEM (NG-SIEM) and Microsoft Sentinel, including detection rule authoring, KQL (Kusto Query Language) development, platform tuning and Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) automation. I have owned SIEM engineering and alert triage operations for an 8,000-user organisation, partnering with stakeholders across IT, infrastructure and leadership to continuously improve threat visibility and security posture. My experience spans endpoint, identity, network and cloud security, and I bring a rigorous approach to incident response grounded in the NIST 800-61 framework and MITRE ATT&CK. I am looking to apply my SIEM engineering and security operations expertise within a fast-paced financial services environment.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **SIEM Engineering:** CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM, Microsoft Sentinel, KQL detection rule development, log source onboarding, platform health management, dashboard and workbook creation
- **Detection Engineering and Threat Hunting:** MITRE ATT&CK-aligned detection rules, alert tuning, threat intelligence integration, proactive threat hunting, indicator of compromise (IOC) investigation
- **Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR):** CrowdStrike Falcon Prevent, CrowdStrike Falcon Insight, Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Tanium
- **Identity Security:** Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Azure Active Directory (Microsoft Entra ID), Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM)
- **Incident Response:** NIST 800-61 lifecycle, SOAR playbook automation, Microsoft Sentinel playbooks, security incident ownership end-to-end
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), AppCheck, Nessus
- **Perimeter and Email Security:** Check Point Harmony firewall, Mimecast email security, Microsoft 365 Defender
- **Scripting and Automation:** PowerShell, KQL, SOAR automation development
- **Security Frameworks:** NIST CSF, CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus, MITRE ATT&CK

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL) *March 2025 - Present*

Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer

- Own and operate the organisation's SIEM engineering function across CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM and Microsoft Sentinel, managing platform health, log source onboarding, detection rule lifecycle and performance tuning for an 8,000-user estate.
- Author and continuously tune KQL detection rules in Microsoft Sentinel aligned to MITRE ATT&CK, improving signal-to-noise ratio and reducing false positive alert volume to enable faster, higher-confidence incident escalation.
- Design and deploy SOAR playbooks in Microsoft Sentinel to automate alert triage, containment and enrichment workflows, reducing mean time to respond (MTTR) and freeing analyst capacity for advanced threat investigation.
- Lead security incident response activities in alignment with NIST 800-61, managing the full lifecycle from detection and triage through to containment, eradication, recovery and post-incident review.
- Manage CrowdStrike Falcon Prevent (endpoint protection), Falcon Insight (Endpoint Detection and Response), Falcon Discover (asset visibility) and Falcon Spotlight (vulnerability management) across the enterprise.
- Administer Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), ensuring broad detection coverage across endpoint, identity and Microsoft 365 cloud workloads.
- Govern Azure Active Directory (Microsoft Entra ID), including Conditional Access policy design, MFA enforcement and Single Sign-On (SSO) configuration, reducing identity-based attack risk.

- Manage BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM), controlling privileged account access through least-privilege principles and just-in-time (JIT) provisioning.
- Deliver continuous vulnerability management using Tenable.io, Pentera BAS and AppCheck, correlating findings with SIEM telemetry to prioritise and track remediation.
- Manage perimeter defences including Check Point Harmony firewall and Mimecast email security, maintaining access controls and anti-phishing measures.

University of the Arts, London (UAL) - Cyber Security and Identity *March 2022 - March 2025*

Cyber Security Analyst

- Conducted tier-2 and tier-3 alert investigation and threat analysis in Microsoft Sentinel and CrowdStrike Falcon Insight, escalating confirmed incidents to the senior team for coordinated response.
- Developed Microsoft Sentinel KQL detection queries and analytical dashboards, improving threat visibility across user, endpoint and network data sources.
- Contributed to the phased rollout of Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) to 8,000 devices, including policy configuration, exclusion management and post-deployment tuning.
- Managed Azure Active Directory identity governance including Conditional Access policy implementation, MFA rollout and SSO configuration for hybrid and cloud applications.
- Performed vulnerability assessments using Tenable.io and Nessus, generating risk-rated reports and tracking remediation progress with infrastructure and application owners.
- Supported security incident response operations aligned to NIST 800-61, including containment, investigation and recovery for phishing, malware and account compromise events.
- Administered Tanium endpoint management platform for software asset inventory, patch compliance and real-time endpoint interrogation.
- Maintained Intune MDM and MAM policies to enforce corporate data protection on managed Windows, iOS and Android devices.

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech) *February 2021 - March 2022*

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

- Delivered security, quality and infrastructure engineering for a SaaS supplier management platform serving financial services clients, ensuring platform availability, security and compliance.
- Configured and managed firewall rules, VPN and network access controls to protect cloud-hosted and on-premises environments.
- Applied CIS Controls security hardening baselines across server and endpoint infrastructure, reducing configuration vulnerabilities.
- Administered Microsoft 365 including Azure Active Directory, Exchange Online and Teams, managing user access, security policies and data governance.
- Supported vulnerability identification and remediation tracking, collaborating with development teams to resolve security issues in the SaaS platform.
- Automated routine infrastructure and security operations tasks using PowerShell scripting.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Engineered a mature SIEM detection library in CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM and Microsoft Sentinel covering over 50 detection use cases across endpoint, identity, network and cloud attack surfaces.
- Automated triage of high-volume low-fidelity alerts through SOAR playbooks in Microsoft Sentinel, significantly reducing manual analyst workload and improving operational efficiency.
- Delivered full CrowdStrike Falcon suite deployment and ongoing management for an 8,000-user estate, achieving rapid time-to-visibility on endpoint threats.
- Introduced Pentera BAS to validate SIEM detection coverage continuously against simulated attack techniques, identifying and closing detection gaps proactively.
- Attained Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) certification while delivering senior security engineering responsibilities full-time.
- Contributed to achieving and maintaining Cyber Essentials Plus certification, demonstrating compliance with UK government-mandated security standards.

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
- CompTIA Security+
- Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
- CompTIA A+
- Google IT Support Professional Certificate

References available on request | Hybrid (London/UK)